Johan **Callermo** | Economist

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Profile

I am a PhD student in economics, with my defense planned for spring 2027. My research interests include competition, regulation, innovation, trade and security. My thesis focuses on the "legal infrastructure" of market economies, with a particular emphasis on European competition law. I have a professional background in the international non-profit sector and substantial leadership experience. My practical skillset includes dealing quantitatively with large text-based datasets using OCR tools, web scraping, database management, machine learning strategies and econometrics.

Education

Stockholm School of Economics **Stockholm, Sweden**
PhD student in Economics (defense planned: spring of 2027) *2020–2027*
Dissertation: *Essays on Competition, Regulation and Firm Productivity.*

Stockholm School of Economics **Stockholm, Sweden**
BSc in Business & Economics *2017–2020*
Specializations: Economics and Accounting
Thesis: "Using Voting Rights to Estimate Swedish Wealth Inequality in the Late Nineteenth Century" (coauthored with Johan Allen).

Swedish Defence University **Stockholm, Sweden**
Political Science, 60 ECTS *2011–2012*
Specialization in crisis management and international cooperation.

Professional Experience

University of Bonn Macrofinance and Microhistory Lab **Remote**
Research Assistant, ERC SafeHouse project *2018–2020*
- Constructed Nordic datasets on privately held real estate and mortgages and digitized historical stock market data.

YWCA-YMCA of Sweden (KFUM Sverige) **Stockholm, Sweden**
Secretary for Local Associations *2014–2016*
- Tasked with incorporating the operations of the Triangle Association (below) into a new organizational structure.
- Worked in a team of three where I held overall responsibility for the budget.
- Coordinated international projects in the Nordics and in southern Africa.

Triangle Association of the Swedish YWCA-YMCA (Triangelförbundet) **Stockholm, Sweden**
General Secretary *2013–2014*
- Sole employee of this NGO with approx. 13,000 members in 51 local associations across Sweden (local associations included summer camps, after-school activities and social projects such as Fryshuset).
- Supported local associations with financing, knowledge exchange, implementation of national strategies and training of volunteers.
- Project manager of this organization's merger with the YWCA-YMCA of Sweden, see above.

Current Research Projects

"Legal Uncertainty in European Merger Control" *2026*
Job Market Paper
Uses the full set of merger control decisions by the EC Directorate General for Competition since 1990 and all related Court of Justice judgments to study how the accumulation of case law in European merger control gradually reduces industry-specific legal uncertainty. Falling legal uncertainty in turn improves selection into merger attempts, reducing the frequency of costly interventions and the risk of unproblematic mergers being foregone because of legal risk.

"Geoeconomic Rivalry with Heterogeneous Firms" *2026*
Manuscript
Studies asymmetric third-country effects of trade liberalization in a trade model with heterogeneous firms and endogenous markups. Shows how asymmetric trade networks can feature "competition choke points" whereby particular industries are sensitive to trade manipulation by rival nations such that profitability and Schumpeterian entry can be impaired at minimal cost to the rival.

Publications

Callermo, J. (2025) "Case law in European merger control"
International Review of Law and Economics. *2025*
Compiled an original dataset of European merger control decisions and associated Court of Justice case law spanning 1990–2022, using web scraping and text analysis to structure a complex legal corpus with extensive metadata and internal linkages. Developed econometric models to disentangle temporal, industry-related and regulatory patterns of case law citations, expanding on previous research about EU merger control by accounting for how evolving case law continuously updates the de facto legal environment.

Presentations

2023: CRESSE, 17th International Conference on Competition and Regulation

2023: NORIO XII (Nordic Workshop on Industrial Organization)

Teaching Experience

Stockholm School of Economics **Stockholm, Sweden**
Teaching Assistant *2020–2025*
- Global Challenges (BSc Business & Economics, Prof. Tore Ellingsen): yearly 2020–2025.
- Foundations of the Global Economy (MSc International Business, Prof. Jesper Roine): yearly 2022–2025.

Skills

Programming and data: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, SQL, OCR, web scraping, machine learning.

Languages: English (professional), Swedish (professional).

Volunteering and civic engagement

2010–2026: Election officer, polling station chair (Swedish general elections and EU elections).

2009–2018: Outdoor educator with the Swedish YWCA-YMCA (kayaking, expeditions, leadership, safety).

2023–2026: Chairman, housing cooperative (bostadsrättsförening).

References

Prof. Richard Friberg
Dept. of Economics, Stockholm School of Economics *Supervisor*

Prof. Tore Ellingsen
Dept. of Economics, Stockholm School of Economics

Prof. Jesper Roine
Stockholm Institute of Transition Economics (SITE)